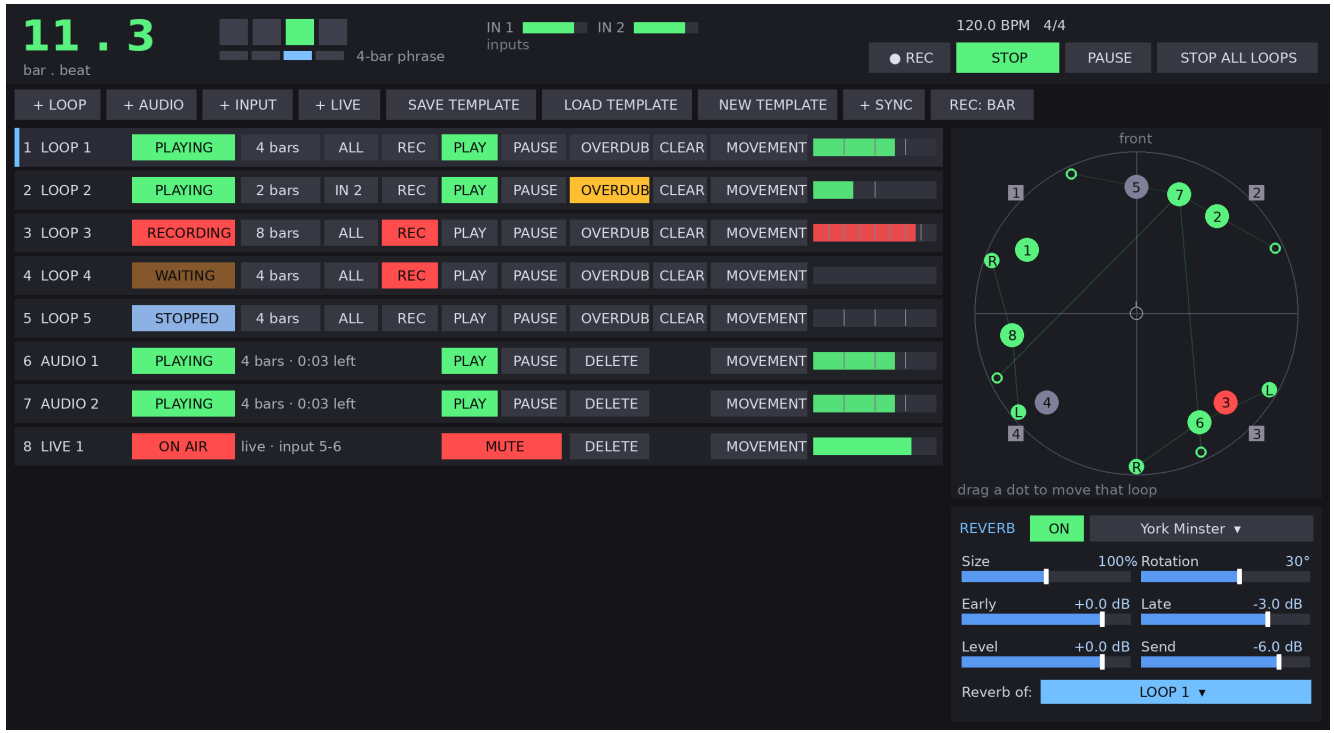
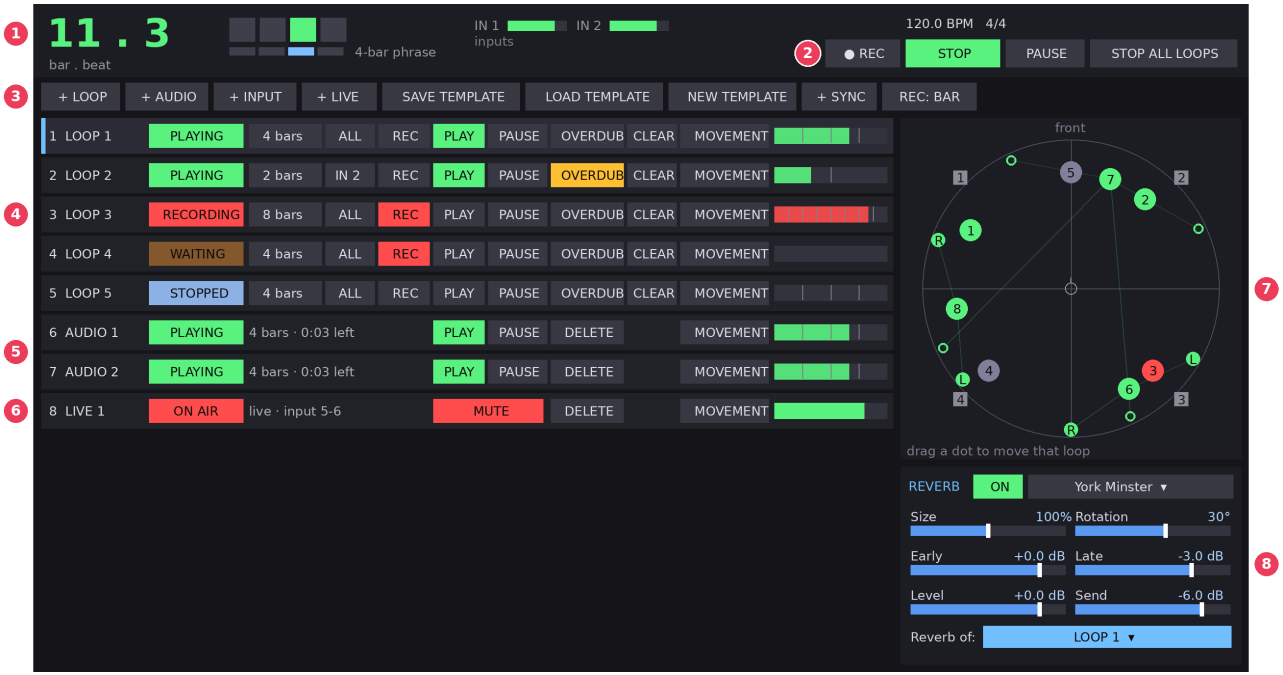
E4L for REAPER

Quick guide · live looping in quad with Envelop movements



1	2	3	4
Run **E4L - Update from GitHub** (Actions › Show action list, search “E4L”)	Run **E4L - New live project** (Enter to accept the dialog)	Set the **tempo** and press **space** (play)	Press **REC** on a loop and play the synth

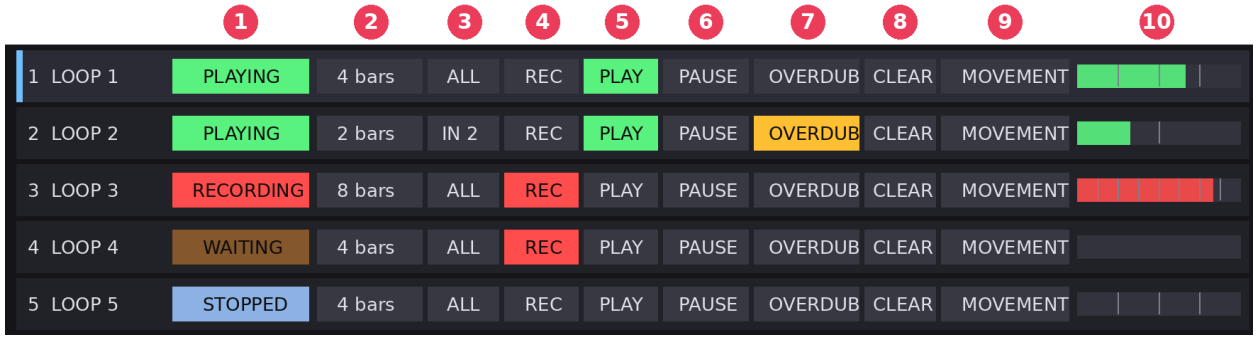
The Live Panel at a glance



1	**Where you are**: bar . beat, the beats, the 4-bar phrase, input levels.
2	● **REC** the session · **PLAY/STOP** (back to bar 1) · **PAUSE** · **STOP ALL LOOPS**.
3	**Toolbar**: add loops, files, inputs, live inputs, sync; templates; REC mode.
4	**Loops**: one row each.
5	**Audio files**: looped files.
6	**Live inputs**: VCV Rack or a synth, played (not looped) in the room.
7	**The room** seen from above: speakers 1-4 and one dot per track. Drag a dot to move it.
8	**Reverb**: one room reverb for everything.

Open it: Actions › Show action list › **E4L - Live Panel**. Dock it with a right-click on its top area. Keys: **space** play/stop · **1-9** REC on loop 1-9 · **0** stop all loops · **Esc** close the editor.

Record a loop



1	**State**: empty, waiting, recording, playing, stopped, paused.
2	**Length**: 1-32 bars or **FREE** (REC again ends it).
3	**Input**: ALL or IN 1, IN 2…
4	**REC**: records, then plays by itself.
5	**PLAY**: start / stop on the next bar.
6	**PAUSE**: silent at once; again = continues at once.
7	**OVERDUB**: add a layer (next page).
8	**CLEAR**: erase the loop.
9	**MOVEMENT**: how it moves in the room.
10	Where the loop is.

1	2	3	4	5
REAPER **playing** (space)	Listen to the synth on the **headphones**	**REC** on a loop (it blinks: waiting)	Red: **recording**	Green: **playing** in the room



REC: BAR / BEAT / NOW (toolbar) – when REC starts: on the next **bar**, the next **beat**, or **at once** (you keep time). With length **FREE** the REC button reads **END**: press it to close the loop where you want.

Overdub: layers on top of a loop



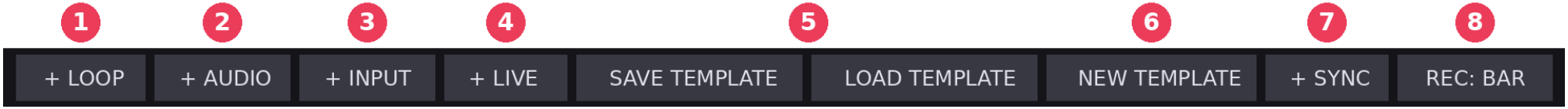
1	2	3	4
The loop is **playing**	Press **OVERDUB** (orange)	Play: it is **added** on top, every pass	Press **OVERDUB** again to stop

Overdub starts and stops **at once** (not on the bar). Layers add up: watch the level. There is no undo of one layer: **CLEAR** erases the whole loop. The new layer moves with the loop's MOVEMENT.

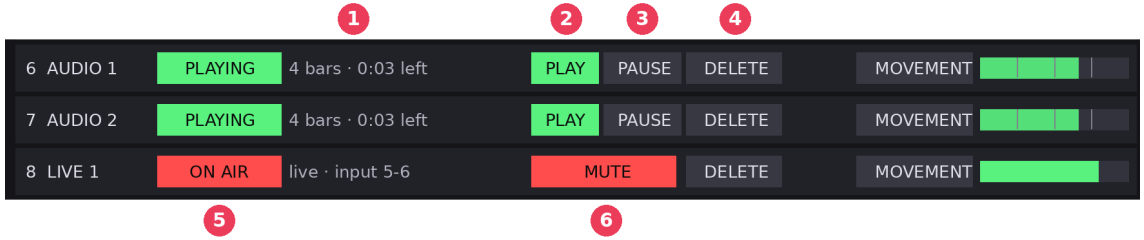
Play / pause

1	2	3	4
PLAY: the loop starts from its beginning on the next bar (or stops on the next bar)	**PAUSE**: silent at once	**PAUSE** again: continues at once from the same point (like tape)	**PLAY**: back on the bars

Add sounds

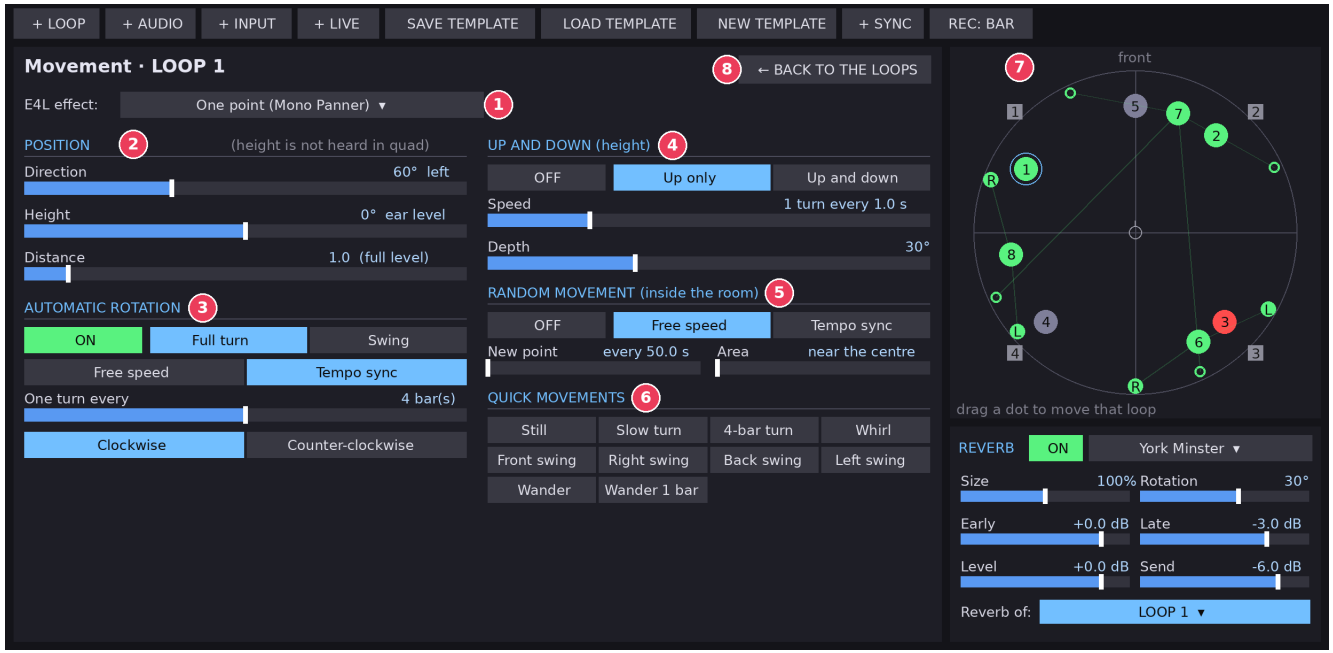


1. **+ LOOP**: one more loop track.
2. **+ AUDIO**: a sound file, looped from bar 1 (or **drag files from the Finder** onto the panel). Mono, stereo or quad: it spreads over the speakers by itself.
3. **+ INPUT**: one more interface input for the loops (IN 2…).
4. **+ LIVE**: an input played live in the room with its own movement (VCV Rack via BlackHole, another synth). Not looped.
5. **SAVE / LOAD TEMPLATE**: keep the set-up of a piece (tracks, files, movements, tempo).
6. **NEW TEMPLATE**: a new live project.
7. **+ SYNC**: clock / reset pulses for an analog sequencer (then a menu: on/off, settings, output).
8. **REC: BAR / BEAT / NOW**: when loops start recording.



1. Time left in the file (orange near the end: get ready).
2. **PLAY**: from the start on the next bar.
3. **PAUSE**: silent; again = goes on from that bar.
4. **DELETE**: click twice.
5. **ON AIR**: the live input is in the room.
6. **MUTE**: out at once.

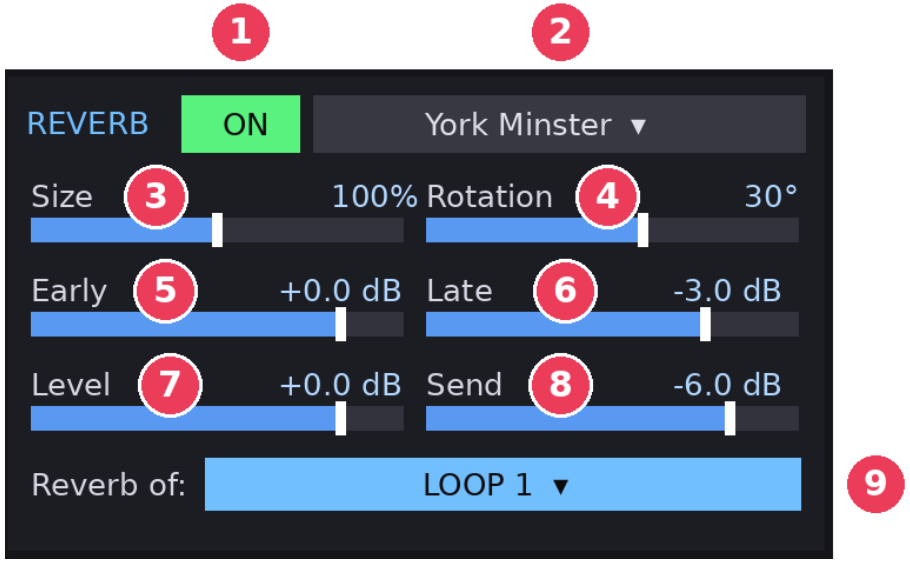
Move the sound: MOVEMENT



1	**E4L effect**: one point, two points (stereo), four (quad)…
2	**Position**: direction, height, distance.
3	**Automatic rotation**: full turn or swing, in seconds or in bars.
4	**Up and down** (little effect in quad).
5	**Random movement**: wanders inside the room.
6	**Quick movements**: one click.
7	Drag a dot to place a track.
8	**BACK TO THE LOOPS** (or Esc).

Open it with the **MOVEMENT** button of a row. Movements freeze on PAUSE and continue; after STOP they start again from the beginning.

Reverb



1	**ON / OFF** (first time: **+ REVERB**).
2	**Room**: choose the room.
3	**Size**: smaller / bigger room.
4	**Rotation**: turns the reflections.
5	**Early**: first reflections.
6	**Late**: the long tail.
7	**Level**: the whole reverb.
8	**Send**: how much reverb the chosen track gets (left end = off).
9	**Reverb of ▾**: choose the track (or click a row's name: blue edge).

1	2	3	4
+ REVERB (once per project)	**Reverb of ▾** choose a track	**Send**: start near −10 dB	**Room, Size, Late** by ear

Changing room or size takes a second or two (“building…”). The reverb uses about 20 % of one CPU core. More rooms: copy 4-channel B-format WAV files to Data/E4L/ir in REAPER's resource folder.

Reverb and movement

\+ **What it does**: puts the sounds **inside a room** (they no longer stick to the speakers), gives **depth** (more reverb = farther; with **Distance** in MOVEMENT the coming and going is much clearer) and, by contrast, helps to follow a moving sound.

− **What it does not do**: the reverb does **not follow** the sound. Each track sends only its non-directional signal, so the room answers the same whether the sound is in front or behind. Only the direct sound moves.

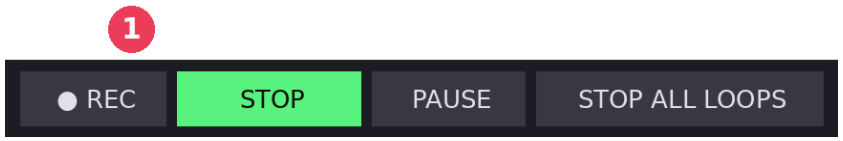
− **Too much reverb blurs the movement**: a loud tail (**Late**) washes out the position. Moderate amounts show movement best.

Check it by ear (in the middle of the 4 speakers, or on the headphones)

1	2	3	4
A/B: a short, percussive loop with **Slow turn**; switch **Send** between off and −12 dB several times. Is the turn easier to follow?	**Solo the REVERB track**: while the loop turns the reverb stays still; moving **Rotation** turns it.	**Depth**: a still sound, raise **Send** and **Distance**: farther. Lower Send, closer: more present.	**Early vs Late**: Late −20 dB, Early 0 = room shape, position kept. Then the reverse: the tail hides the movement.

Starting point for clear movement: Send −15 to −10 dB · Late −3 to −6 dB · Early 0 dB.

Record the session and export it



● **REC** records what goes to the 4 speakers (two tracks REC 1-2 and REC 3-4). **Save the project first** (the files go into its folder). ● REC again, or STOP, ends it.

1	2	3	4
● **REC** play your set	● **REC** again (or STOP)	Run **E4L - Binaural mix of the session**	Press **Render**: a binaural stereo file

Control it with MIDI

1	2	3	4
Actions › **Show action list**	Search **E4L ctl** (e.g. E4L ctl - LOOP 1 REC)	**Add…**	Press the button on the controller

Every panel button has its action: LOOP 1-12 REC / PLAY / PAUSE / OVERDUB / CLEAR, AUDIO 1-6 PLAY / PAUSE, LIVE 1-4 ON-OFF, MASTER PLAY-STOP / PAUSE / REC SESSION / STOP ALL LOOPS / REC START. Knobs and faders: open the plug-in, **Param** › **Learn**.

Update

1	2	3	4
Run **E4L - Update from GitHub**	It downloads and installs (REAPER keeps working)	**Yes** to reopen the project (new plug-ins)	The panel opens again

Good to know

- **Recorded loops live in memory**: they are not saved with the project and are lost when it is reopened. Use ● **REC** to keep a performance.
- REAPER must be **playing** for the loops to record and play.
- The synth comes in hot: keep its level below 0 dB on the IN meter, and watch it when overdubbing.
- Outputs: speakers **1-4**, sub **5**, headphones **7-8** (binaural). The synth goes to the headphones only, until it is recorded in a loop.
- If a loop sounds early or late, adjust **Recording Latency Compensation** in its E4L Looper.
- The full guide (every control) is **E4L_REAPER_Guide.pdf**, next to this one in REAPER's resource folder › Data › E4L.